



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Smith Preparatory Academy
School Website: <https://www.smithprep.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Smith Preparatory Academy Florida 32752 (Smith Prep) presents a clearly classical, Christian-language model of education rooted in the liberal-arts tradition. Public-facing materials describe a Christian classical framework with Cottage and Traditional programs, emphasis on virtuous formation, and deep integration of faith, pedagogy, and community life. Core elements such as the grammar-stage approach, Common Arts offerings, Latin emphasis, and a stated mission to recover Christian humanism align with classical rubric expectations. The school also foregrounds partnerships with parents and a donor-supported mission to sustain the program through faith-infused resources.

Overall, the school demonstrates strong alignment with Classical education across all six rubric categories. The presence of explicit religious foundations, a purpose oriented toward virtue and wisdom, a curriculum that centers grammar/logic/rhetoric and Great-Conversation style learning through Western-Christian heritage, contemplative and participatory pedagogy, clearly described faculty expectations, and a robust parent/community partnering ethos supports a classification of CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive-level insights: - Religious foundations and liturgical framing are integrated into daily life and academics (evidence of theology, liturgy, Christian formation, and explicit references to God, Scripture, and Church across mission and program descriptions). □filecite□turn0file1□turn0file17□ - The curriculum explicitly articulates grammar, logic, and rhetoric through a classical framework, including grammar-stage memory work, Latin, and a Great-Conversation ethos in spirit (textual emphasis on classical disciplines and Western tradition). □filecite□turn0file16□turn0file12□ - Pedagogy is described as contemplative/restful in lower grades with singing/memory, alongside higher-level rhetoric and potential Socratic-style engagement in upper grades; the site emphasizes both Schol  -like memory work and rhetoric training. - Faculty are framed as mentors within a living curriculum; parental partnership is emphasized as co-teachers in formation, with visible programs to engage families. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file17□

Notes on methodology: - The assessment leverages the six-category classical rubric (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose and Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community) drawn from the classical-education lexicon in the provided knowledge files (Six Essential Elements and related lexicon). Positive/Negative keyword indicators guide category scoring, with explicit textual evidence drawn from Smith Prep's public-facing materials (web site and blogs) and the classical-lexicon framework. See the cited source materials for the exact keyword inventories and matched terms.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school identifies itself as a Christian classical school and centers formation around God, Scripture, and Church. The mission statements repeatedly reference Christian virtue, the world God has made, and the Church He has redeemed.

- The Mission & Values page articulates Our Vision (“virtuous scholars who advance God’s Kingdom”) and Our Mission (“highest quality classical Christian education, cultivating Christian virtue, recovering Christian humanism”).
- Liturgy, prayer, and spiritual formation are woven into community life (references to liturgy/prayer and liturgical themes in content such as blog topics and mission statements).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: God, Christian, Scripture, Church, liturgy, worship, theology, virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, imago Dei, sacred, sacred music, awe/reverence, prayer, Gospel, spiritual formation. These align with Positive indicators in the lexicon. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file12□
 - Negative keywords: none clearly evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, secular humanism, or values-clarification signals appear in the published content). The lexicon warns of those signals, but they are not present in the public materials here.
- Why this rating
 - The public-facing materials foreground religious foundations, liturgical life, and theological framing as core to both mission and daily practice. The textual emphasis on God, Scripture, Church, liturgy, and virtue-outlined formation meets the Positive keywords signaling a Classical Religious/Metaphysical Foundation. The absence of clear negative signals further supports CLASSICAL here. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file17□

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission and vision emphasize formation, virtue, and wisdom; the aim is to cultivate Christian virtue and recover Christian humanism, not solely job-readiness. The language centers on telos, virtue, and human flourishing within a liberal-arts frame.
 - Public materials describe education as formation in virtue and wisdom, with a commitment to the Western, Christian intellectual tradition (Great Books/Great Conversation-like framing implicit in “classical Christian education” and Western heritage emphasis).
 - There is recognition of preparing students for college/post-secondary pursuits as part of the academic program and accreditation standards, but the core aim remains formation and classical formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, true/good/beautiful, telos, great conversation (as a classical aim), human flourishing, classical mission, wisdom-prudence-justice-temperance-fortitude. □filecite□turn0file17□turn0file12□
 - Negative keywords: explicit workforce-preparation signals are not dominant; there is a single mention of college/post-secondary readiness within academics, which is not framed as the primary goal. No overt signals of “career readiness” overshadow the formation aim.
- Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth/beauty as the telos of education, consistent with Classical aims. While college readiness is acknowledged in the Academic materials, it does not dominate the messaging; formation and virtue are clearly primary. Therefore CLASSICAL is warranted.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The curriculum explicitly references grammar, logic, and rhetoric in the classical framework (grammar-stage emphasis, Latin, history through a Western tradition, and engagement with old texts). The presence of low- to high-school sequences aligns with classical curricula: grammar stage in early years; logic, rhetoric and great-literary tradition in later years; common arts program (gardening, woodworking, etc.) as part of a broad classical curriculum.
 - The school emphasizes Latin and study of great traditions (Latin is highlighted as forming intellect and connecting students to Augustine, Aquinas, and Western Christian heritage).

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- Public materials reference a curriculum rooted in Western civilization, Christian tradition, and the common-arts extension of classical education.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation (spirited by Western-Christian tradition), Latin, history (as a continuous thread, not just social studies), wonder, sacred/holy, classical education, liberal arts, memory-work, recitation, chant, guardianship of tradition. [filecite turn0file16 turn0file12](#)
 - Negative keywords: the explicit negation signals (e.g., “social studies terminology replacing history,” “project-based learning dominance”) are part of the lexicon, not the Smith Prep site, and public content clearly centers classical methods rather than solely project-based or STEM-first framing. The site’s own content does not foreground project-based-dominant pedagogy; rather, it emphasizes classical methods.
 - Why this rating
 - The curriculum is described through multiple elements consistent with classical education: grammar-stage memorization, Latin, Great-Books-oriented framing via Western-Christian tradition, and integrated classical disciplines. While explicit “Great Books” phrasing is not always overt in every page, the structure, language, and emphasis on Western tradition and classical disciplines align with CLASSICAL. [filecite turn0file0 turn0file12](#)

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Lower-grade pedagogy emphasizes memory, singing, recitation, chanting, and restfulness (Scholé-like approach) as part of the learning process. Upper-grade pedagogy is described in ways consistent with Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training. The public materials describe a continuum from repertory memory in the grammar stage to rhetoric and public speaking in higher grades.
 - The Cottage/Traditional structure explicitly ties pedagogy to a classical framework (memory work, recitation, and integration of liturgical/community forms). There are mentions of opportunities for students to give speeches and to engage in rhetoric-related activities.
 - The Great Arts/Common Arts component indicates experiential, memory-oriented, and contemplative elements in lower grades, with more discussion-based or advanced discourse in upper grades.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: scholé, memory work, recitation, chanting, singing, wonder, contemplation/restful learning, Socratic discussion (implied in upper grades), seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking, masterful instruction.
 - Negative keywords: where present in lexicon, we would note signals like project-based learning dominating; however, Smith Prep’s site foregrounds classical methods rather than project-only pedagogy, and the explicit articulation of restfulness and Socratic/lectures in upper levels appears. No explicit “experiential-only” or “constructivist” framing dominates the site. The absence of negative pedagogy terms on the main site supports a CLASSICAL rating.
- Why this rating
 - The pedagogy aligns with classical education conventions: memory/recitation in early years, liturgical/restful elements, and rhetoric/seminar-style oration in later years. The presented evidence supports CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials describe faculty as “exceptional” and as the guiding force of the program (cottage/Traditional). The language emphasizes faculty as mentors and living curriculum, with a faculty-led approach to formation and scholarship. There are explicit references to faculty as part of community and to a “portrait” or “profile” of what a teacher should be.

- The site presents an integrated, long-standing faculty-informed culture (since 1994) with a focus on virtue, mastery, and classical formation.
- Administrative and faculty pages (e.g., Mission & Values, Administration, Faculty & Staff) foreground a teacher-centered and virtue-centered framework, consistent with living-curriculum and virtuous mentorship.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentor, master-teacher, virtuous teachers, character formation, faculty as the core, portrait of teacher/student ideals, collegial culture, formation-focused.
 - Negative keywords: not prominently present in public content (no signals of low teacher quality, or outsourcing education to non-personalized models). The lexicon's negative signals concern pedagogy without classical grounding, not observed here.
- Why this rating
 - The public statements position faculty as central living exemplars and core to the school's ethos, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations of teacher as mentor and living curriculum.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school emphasizes partnership with parents, describes parents as co-teachers, and outlines family involvement through a variety of formats (parent formation, book studies, gatherings, and open-campus opportunities). Demonstrated donor engagement also indicates a strong community- and family-centered ethos (Celestial City Fund; SPEF).
 - The school highlights active family participation, tours, and open visits, highlighting a welcoming environment for parent involvement.
 - Public materials discuss working with parents to address spiritual needs and to coordinate with families in the classical mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parent formation, classical book clubs, open-campus/visits, family participation, engagement with the school mission.
 - Negative keywords: none evident in public content; there is no sign of a customer-service orientation that minimizes parent involvement. The lexicon's negative signals (e.g., "customer" orientation) do not appear in the public materials.
- Why this rating
 - The public materials show robust parent engagement and community involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for active parental partnership and shared formation.

What Would Move the Needle

- Given the aggregate CLASSICAL rating across categories, no major needle-moving changes are required. If the school sought to reach a surer "CLASSICAL" designation in every sub-criterion, it could enhance explicit articulation of:
 - A more explicit Great Books/Great Conversation articulation in program pages (beyond Western tradition and Latin) to foreground the Great Conversation as a classroom practice.
 - More explicit references to Socratic dialogue/university-level seminars and demonstrable opportunities for extended Socratic discourse in upper grades (where not already explicit) to strengthen the Pedagogy category further.
 - Clear articulation of a full, graded integration of Latin and logic/rhetoric across the upper grades as well as explicit mention of classical memory work across the curriculum to reinforce Curriculum and Pedagogy signals.
- Concrete examples (potential steps):
 - Add a page section detailing Great Books/Great Conversation commitments and representative book lists.

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- Provide examples of Socratic seminars and student-led debates in upper grades with sample rubrics.
 - Publish a teacher-mentorship portrait and a formal “living curriculum” description with examples of how faculty model virtue and mastery across disciplines.
 - Create a formal parent-formation series (book studies or lectures) that aligns with classical aims and documents participation metrics.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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